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Teaching Statement

Introduction

I enjoy teaching. I particularly enjoy helping students make sense of work they find difficult. I feel satisfaction when they make progress in this way. Typically, this progress grows out of one-on-one or small group coaching. I see time spent answering questions and revisiting explanations as an essential part of teaching. Across introductory courses and advanced topics, I encourage students to question assumptions, explain their reasoning, and apply economics to real-life situations.

At Binghamton University, I taught Statistical Methods in Summer 2025. I designed the syllabus, lectures, problem sets, data exercises, and assessments around the course's learning objectives. I emphasized statistical reasoning and the interpretation of results. My teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, econometrics, and data analytics. I supported Principles of Macroeconomics in Spring 2023 and Spring 2025. In Introduction to Econometrics, I also lead R instruction.

Teaching Philosophy

My teaching philosophy centers on rigorous reasoning, active practice, and accessible support. I want students to become independent thinkers who can use economics to examine unfamiliar problems. They should explain an argument, work through its formal reasoning, and interpret the result. They should also understand why a method fits a question and where its assumptions limit the conclusions. I connect intuition, formal methods, and applications to help students develop these abilities.

A central challenge is that students can follow a worked solution without being able to reproduce its reasoning. In Introduction to Econometrics, students struggled to derive ordinary least squares estimators and prove their unbiasedness and consistency. I returned to the foundations. I derived the estimators through least squares and the method of moments. I then worked through the proofs and explained the assumptions each required. Students explained the reasoning back to me and derived the estimators in class. Their responses helped me judge when they were ready for policy applications and hypothesis testing. I also organized extra classes and additional office hours.

Participation helps me identify difficulties that might otherwise remain hidden. I invite questions and call on students at random to explain their reasoning. I explain that incorrect answers are a natural part of learning. We can identify a mistaken step, revisit the concept, and work toward the correct answer. I respond respectfully while making the correction clear. I recognize that students differ in how quickly they organize their thoughts. I encourage them to work through their reasoning, even when their answers are incomplete.

Students enter economics courses with different levels of mathematical and programming preparation. My approach gives them several ways to revisit foundations while working toward the same learning objectives. I assigned weekly homework and additional practice questions. I created lecture videos on difficult concepts and shared slides and notes. Students could pause a recording and return to a difficult step at their own pace. An online collaboration platform let them discuss concepts with classmates before bringing unresolved questions to me. Flexible office hours provided individual support. These resources allow students to seek help without having to raise every question in class. In future courses, I will pair assignment solutions with explanations of the reasoning and common mistakes.

In microeconomics, I ask students to predict the effects of a tax. They work through the graph and explain the result in words. This connects their economic reasoning to its graphical representation. In R instruction, I link data preparation, estimation, and interpretation through practical examples and reproducible scripts. I explain the econometric ideas alongside the code. Students can then see how a concept guides the steps of an analysis.

My industry experience reinforces the importance of making analysis useful to others. At First Bank of Nigeria, I developed customer-dormancy and transaction-channel models to support retention and service decisions. This experience informs my emphasis on clear explanations and documentation that another person can follow. My Nigerian banking research, published in *Economic Modelling* (2026), offers an application connecting theory, estimation, and interpretation. Its public replication code provides material for future reproducibility exercises.

Evidence

Preparation, explanation, and support. Seven of nine students responded to my Summer 2025 Statistical Methods evaluation. On a five-point scale, students rated my preparation at 4.43 on average and my explanations of complex material at 4.17. The mean ratings for encouraging analytical thinking and availability outside class were both 4.14. These ratings describe students' experiences of my teaching. I consider them alongside students' explanations and in-class work when reflecting on my instruction.

Clear explanations. In my econometrics TA evaluation, a student described how my support made difficult material more manageable: "The course was interesting and even though challenging at times it was manageable with the TA's help and explanations."

Class participation. Another student described how random calling helped surface questions students hesitated to ask: "So with the random calling it does help us go over things that we need help with and are too nervous to talk about." This feedback suggests that structured participation can help reveal unresolved difficulties. I also recognize that students differ in their comfort with speaking in class. Opportunities to ask questions through peer discussion and individual support complement classroom participation.

Conclusion

I am prepared to teach principles and intermediate microeconomics and macroeconomics, statistics for economists, and introductory and intermediate econometrics. My goal is to pair rigorous standards with support that helps students meet them. Through explanation, practice, and feedback, I want students to develop confidence in their reasoning. They should leave my courses better able to assess economic arguments and communicate their conclusions clearly.